

THE PLUG AI

Business Plan

AI literacy for the people the tech world forgot

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1. Executive Summary

The Plug AI is a community AI literacy initiative serving south suburban Cook County, Illinois. AI is changing how people find work, learn, and access services. The communities we serve are being left out of that change. The Plug AI closes the gap with hands on training built for faith communities, community health workers, and first generation college students.

The brand, product requirements, and entity path analysis are complete. The public platform is live at theplugai.info. A letter of inquiry has been submitted to the Kresge Foundation, and the Illinois Eliminate the Digital Divide program, with grants of up to \$75,000, is the primary live funding opportunity. The immediate priority is securing a 501(c)(3) fiscal sponsor and community partner so grant applications can move forward.

Tagline: Get Connected. Get Skilled. Get into AI.

2. Mission and Vision

Mission. Close the AI literacy gap for people the tech world forgot.

Vision. A south suburban Cook County where church members, health workers, and first generation students use AI with confidence, on their own terms, for their own goals.

Values. Plain language. Real skills. Community trust. No fear, no hype.

3. The Problem

AI adoption is accelerating in every industry. Training, tooling, and hiring pipelines concentrate in communities that already have access. South suburban Cook County residents face a compounding gap:

- Workers see AI reshaping their jobs with no accessible on ramp to learn it.
- Community institutions, especially churches, are trusted hubs with no technology programming.
- Community health workers are asked to use digital tools without training designed for their work.
- First generation students lack the informal networks where AI skills currently spread.

National digital equity funding recognizes this gap. Illinois' Eliminate the Digital Divide program exists precisely to fund community technology centers that close it.

4. Programs

4.1 Faith community workshops

Hands on AI literacy workshops hosted in partner churches. Members learn practical uses: writing, job search, small business tasks, ministry administration. Faith community content is The Plug AI's strongest performing outreach channel by a wide margin, validating this audience first strategy.

4.2 Community health worker training

Applied AI training for community health workers: documentation, outreach materials, translation support, and scheduling, aligned with the tools they already use in the field.

4.3 First generation student pathways

Skill building sessions that take students from AI consumer to AI operator: prompt fundamentals, study workflows, portfolio projects, and an introduction to AI related career paths.

4.4 Digital platform

theplugai.info carries program information, an email capture funnel for workshop interest, and educational content. The site underwent a full content integrity pass in July 2026 so that every claim, statistic, and testimonial shown is real.

5. Community and Market

Audience	Reached through	First offer
Faith communities	Church partnerships, LinkedIn faith content	On site AI literacy workshop series
Community health workers	Health organization partnerships	Applied AI training for field work
First generation students	Schools, community programs	AI skills and career pathway sessions

The service area is south suburban Cook County, a region with strong community institutions and persistent underinvestment in technology access. The trusted messenger model, working through churches and community organizations rather than around them, is the core differentiator.

6. Organization

The Plug AI is founder led by Stefan Morris, whose background spans healthcare operations, education technology, and training development, with certifications from Google and IBM in IT support and UX design and an in progress computer science degree.

The entity path analysis compared an LLC, a standalone 501(c)(3), and fiscal sponsorship. The selected path is fiscal sponsorship first: partner with an established 501(c)(3) to accept grants and donations now, then convert to a standalone 501(c)(3) as revenue justifies it.

7. Funding Strategy

Source	Amount	Status
Illinois Eliminate the Digital Divide	Up to \$75,000	Live option; requires community partner
Kresge Foundation	TBD	Letter of inquiry submitted
Woods Fund Chicago	TBD	Application prep in progress
Individual giving via fiscal sponsor	Ongoing	Opens once sponsor is secured

The critical dependency for the primary grant is a partner organization with 501(c)(3) status and community facilities. Securing that partnership is the top near term objective and the subject of the accompanying request for proposals.

8. Roadmap

- Q3 2026 — Secure fiscal sponsor and host partner. Confirm first workshop date and venue.

- Q4 2026 — Submit Illinois Eliminate the Digital Divide application. Deliver pilot workshop series. Collect real testimonials and outcome data.
- Q1 2027 — Expand to a second host site. Launch community health worker training track.
- Q2 2027 — Evaluate standalone 501(c)(3) filing. Publish first annual community impact report.

9. Risks and Mitigation

Risk	Mitigation
Grant timing slips	Multiple parallel funders; programs sized to run lean on volunteer delivery
Partner church capacity	Simple hosting requirements; The Plug AI supplies curriculum and facilitation
Founder bandwidth	Automation heavy operations; content and admin systems already built
AI tool churn	Curriculum teaches durable fundamentals, not single vendor features